

Notes 7

* Wildcard

- **Definition:** The Asterisk matches none or more characters in the filename.
- **Examples:**
 - Shows all the files in a directory.
`ls Downloads/*`
 - Shows all the text files in the given directory.
`ls Downloads/*.txt`
 - Shows all the files that contain the word file in the name.
`ls *file*`

? Wildcard

- **Definition:** Matches one character precisely.
- **Examples:**
 - Shows all hidden files in a current working directory.
`ls ./.*??*`
 - Shows all hidden files in the parent directory.
`ls ../.*??*`
 - Shows all the files with a 2 letter file extension.
`ls *.??`

[] Wildcard

- **Definition:** The brackets wildcard matches a single character in a range. The brackets wildcard use the exclamation mark to reverse the match.
- **Examples:**
 - Matches all the files that have a vowel after the letter f:
`ls f[aeiou]*`
 - Matches all the files that don't have a vowel after f:
`ls f[!aeiou]*`
 - Matches all the files that have a collection of letters after f:
`ls f[a-z]*`

Brace expansion

- **Definition:** Brace expansion generates strings that can be used by commands to operate files. Instead of making calls, it generates file names based on the pattern given.
- **Examples:**
 - Create 10 files in a range from 0 to 9.

- `touch file{0..9}.txt`
- Remove certain files that start with a keyword.
- `rm image_{01..08}*_camera.{png,jpg}`
- Create 3 different files with the same name but different file extensions.
- `touch file.{md,txt,rtf}`